



EXPRESSING FEELINGS

Your facial expressions reveal your emotions, communicating the way you feel to people around you. It is difficult to fake these expressions, because they are created automatically without us even thinking about it. The three examples shown below illustrate how different facial muscles work to reveal feelings of sadness, anger, and happiness.



◀ SADNESS

If you are feeling sad, the lips close, the lower facial muscles pull the mouth down at its corners, and the forehead muscles pull the eyebrows at their inner ends.



◀ ANGER

When you get angry, muscles pull the eyebrows down and wrinkle them. At the same time the circular eye muscles narrow the eyes, and the mouth muscles purse the lips.



◀ HAPPINESS

A smile is created by the muscles along the cheeks and those that lie along the side of the lips. These muscles stretch the mouth sideways and lift its corners upward.

WOW!

From smiles to scowls, basic facial expressions are understood by people all over the world.

A USEFUL TOOL

Did you know you can use facial expressions to get what you want? Unable to talk, babies use a range of expressions such as gurgling, crying, or widening their eyes to help them get attention or food. Some pets, too, appear to mimic human expressions as a way of communicating.



REBUILDING FACES

Specialized artists combine skill in art with a detailed knowledge of anatomy to rebuild faces from the skulls of those who died recently or long ago. They use various materials to accurately rebuild layers of muscle and skin on the skull. The re-created face can then be used by historians, for example, to provide information about people from our past.



▲ MUSCLE LAYER A forensic artist uses clay to reconstruct facial muscles on a skull.